# 2013 Dodge Challenger SXT

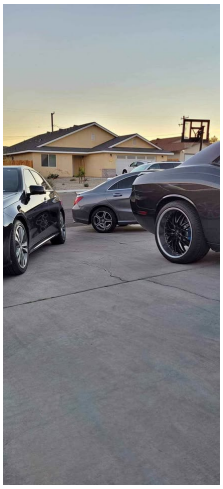
$8,700 · 113,000 miles · Private seller · Ridgecrest, CA

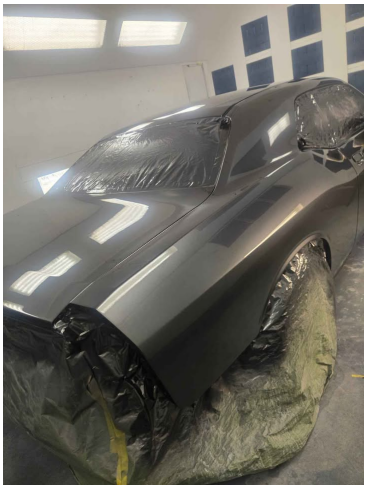
Seller: Private seller

Source: Facebook Marketplace

Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/1405437455036959/

Report generated October 26, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 6 more photos in the app.

| Out-the-door price | Monthly cost to own | Reliability |
|---|---|---|
| **$9,749** | **$665** | **Average** |
| Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare. | loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration | 3/5 · 5 recalls · 179 NHTSA complaints |

## Budget — buying it

| | |
|---|---|
| Vehicle price | $8,700.00 |
| Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV | $804.75 |
| Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price) | $56.55 |
| Registration + CHP fee | $108.00 |
| Transportation improvement fee | $65.00 |
| Title transfer | $15.00 |
| Total out-the-door | $9,749.30 |
| + Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop) | $150.00 |

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

## Budget — paying for it

| | |
|---|---|
| Down payment | $5,000.00 |
| Amount financed | $4,749.30 |
| Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR) | $95.17 |
| Total interest over the loan | $960.67 |
| Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection) | $5,150.00 |

## Budget — owning it each month

| | |
|---|---|
| Loan payment | $95.17 |
| Insurance (estimate, full) | $196.00 |
| Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 21 MPG, $4.75/gal) | $226.19 |
| Maintenance & repair reserve | $130.00 |
| Registration renewal (÷12) | $17.21 |
| Total per month | $664.57 |

Running costs without the loan: **$569/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$17,061** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

## Insurance

| Coverage | Typical Ridgecrest range | Estimate used |
|---|---|---|
| Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15) | $71–$163/mo | $102/mo |
| Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive) | $137–$353/mo | $196/mo |

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($196/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: sporty coupe/sedan. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

## Reliability

**Rating: Average (3/5)**

Average. 3.6L Pentastar V6 + 5-speed auto is a durable combo with maintenance, but early (2011-13) engines had a left cylinder head defect. 179 complaints, mostly electrical.

NHTSA data for this model year: 5 recalls · 179 owner complaints (6 involving a crash). Most complaints: Electrical System (104), Engine (27), Air Bags (19), Power Train (16), Steering (15), Unknown Or Other (11).

**Known issues for this model**

• Left cylinder head defect (cyl #2 valve seat) on engines built before mid-2012/2013 - misfire, ticking

• Plastic oil filter housing cracks -> oil and/or coolant leaks (very common)

• Rocker arm wear ('Pentastar tick')

• Electrical issues (most-complained category)

• Big 22" wheels: expensive tires, harsh ride, bent-rim risk

**Check on this car before buying**

• Check build date on driver door sticker

• Listen for ticking from driver's side at idle

• Look for oil/coolant leaks at the back of the engine valley (oil filter housing)

• Ask if cylinder head was replaced under warranty

• Scan for codes (P0302 / P0304 misfires)

## Notes

$8,700, 113k, automatic, grey/black. Clean title, paid off, claims bought new + maintained. New tires, 22" rims, fresh oil change, SMOG DONE, backup camera, tint. Listed Oct 18.

3.6L V6 Pentastar: early (2011-13) engines had left cylinder head valve-train issue (ticking, misfire cyl 2) - listen for tick. 22" rims = expensive tires, harsh ride.

Ask for service records since new. Local - easy to see.

2026-10-23: LISTING REMOVED - no longer on Facebook Marketplace (likely sold).

## Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.